

Shapeshifter

Waves wear away (erode) the edges of icebergs, creating spectacular arches and caves in the ice. When icebergs grind against the seabed or the shore, they can also get sculpted into different shapes.

Small bits of ice that break off the iceberg are called growlers—they can be a danger for passing ships.

Life on the iceberg

Icebergs host their own mini communities, or ecosystems, of living organisms. They attract tiny algae, krill, and fish. Seabirds, such as petrels and penguins, hunt and feed on these sea creatures.

Tiny sea creatures called krill make a tasty meal for penguins living on the ice.

Colored ice Icebergs are usually white or blue, but algae living on the ice can produce a variety of colors, including green. Some icebergs are rich in iron from rock dust, resulting in a yellow or reddish color.

Only one-eighth of an iceberg floats above the ocean's surface. Most of it is underwater.

Melting away

When icebergs drift into warmer waters or are surrounded by warm air, they start to melt. As the ice melts into pools and cracks form and widen, the iceberg slowly disappears.